Berlin

BRAIN TUMOR MEETING 2026

12th Edition

MAX DELBRÜCK CENTER

Robert-Rössle-Str. 10
13125 Berlin
Germany

SCIENTIFIC PROGRAM

OCTOBER 14-15 · BERLIN

OCTOBER 14–15, 2026

Max Delbrück Center for Molecular Medicine · Berlin

Robert-Rössle-Str. 10 · 13125 Berlin · Germany

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MAX DELBRÜCK CENTER

HELMHOLTZ

DAY 1 — Wednesday, 14 October 2026

MDC.C · BUILDING 83 · MAX DELBRÜCK CENTER

Brain Tumor Origin, Plasticity and Evolution

CHAIR: Rainer Glass

09:30-13:10	REGISTRATION, MDC.C (BUILDING 83) AND POSTER SETUP
11:00-11:05	**Welcome address** *Gaetano Gargiulo, on behalf of the Scientific Committee*
11:10-11:50	KEYNOTE **Jeremy N. Rich**, *University of North Carolina, Chapel Hill* Brain Cancer Through the Lens of Stem Cell Biology
11:50-12:30	KEYNOTE **Jeong Ho Lee**, *KAIST, South Korea* Somatic Mosaicism in Brain Tumor Evolution
12:30-13:10	KEYNOTE **Ghazaleh Tabatabai**, *Tübingen, Germany* Mapping and Targeting Functional Vulnerabilities in Glioblastoma
13:10-14:00	LUNCH BREAK & POSTER SESSION

Glioma Cell Intrinsic Biology

CHAIR: Pilar Sanchez-Bailon

14:00-14:20	**Ashraf Zaman**, *Garvan Institute of Medical Research, Sydney, Australia* A Conserved Astrocyte-Like Parental Cell Defines the Phylogenetic Root of Adult-Type Diffuse Glioma
14:20-14:40	**Kevin Johnson**, *Yale University, USA* Acquired Genetic and Cell State Changes in IDH-Mutant Glioma Progression
14:40-14:50	**Tuğba Bağcı-Önder**, *Koç University, Turkey* Defining Epigenetic Vulnerabilities and Response Programs in IDH-Mutant Gliomas
14:50-15:00	**Elisabetta Stanzani**, *CNR - Istituto di Neuroscienze / Humanitas Research Hospital, Italy* Beyond Oncogenic Mutations: Identifying Actionable Vulnerabilities in BRAF-wt Glioblastoma Resistance
15:00-15:45	COFFEE BREAK & POSTER SESSION

Brain Metastasis

CHAIR: Michela Serresi

15:45-16:25	KEYNOTE **Berta López Sánchez-Laorden**, *Alicante, Spain* Microenvironmental Regulation of Melanoma Brain Metastases
16:25-16:45	**Pedro García-Gómez**, *CNIO, Spain* A Transient MXD4-Dependent Proliferative Pause Enables Survival of Brain Micrometastases
16:45-17:05	**Jan Remsik**, *VIB, Belgium* How Dendritic Cell Maturation Instructs Leptomeningeal Anti-Tumor Immunity
17:05-18:30	COFFEE BREAK & POSTER SESSION

Extended Symposium

Stadtgut historic wooden barn

19:00-20:00	**Flash-oral** Francesca Lessi, Fondazione Pisana per la Scienza Chiara Maria Mazzanti, Fondazione Pisana per la Scienza Mariangela Morelli, Fondazione Pisana per la Scienza Giuseppina Catanzaro, Link University Sukrit Mahajan, TU Dresden Adrián Sanz Gálvez, Universidad Complutense de Madrid
20:00-21:45	**Social Dinner**
21:45-23:00	**Late-breaking Flash-oral**

The brain tumors

PRIMARY AND METASTATIC BRAIN TUMORS

DAY 2 — Thursday, 15 October 2026

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Brain Tumor Immunology

CHAIR: Gaetano Gargiulo

09:30-09:50	**Ahmed Sadik**, *DKFZ/DKTK, Heidelberg, Germany* The Spatial Distribution of Tryptophan Metabolic Fields Promote Niche-Specific Immunosuppressive Programs in Gliomas
09:50-10:00	**Aso Omer Mohammed**, *Universitätsklinikum Freiburg / University Hospital Zurich, Germany/Switzerland* Human Glioma-Infiltrated Brain Slices Reveal Payload-Specific Remodeling by Cytokine-Armored CAR-PBMC
10:00-10:10	**Laurens Zaschke**, *Charité, Berlin, Germany* Dexamethasone Induces Immunosuppressive Remodeling of the Brain Tumor Microenvironment Associated with Poor Prognosis
10:10-10:50	KEYNOTE **Björn Scheffler**, *DKTK/DKFZ, Heidelberg & University Duisburg–Essen, Germany* Glioblastoma at the Brain-Skull Marrow Interface: From Neuroimmune Crosstalk to Clinical Translation
10:50-11:15	**COFFEE BREAK & POSTER SESSION**

Brain Tumor Microenvironment

CHAIR: Charlotte Flüh

11:15-11:55	KEYNOTE **Leila Akkari**, *NKI, Amsterdam, Netherlands* From Diversity to Dependency: Plasticity of Myeloid Cells in Brain Tumors
11:55-12:35	KEYNOTE **Simona Parrinello**, *UCL, London, UK* The Role of Injury Programs in Gliomagenesis
12:35-12:55	**Alexander Pietras**, *Lund, Sweden* Phenotypic Screening Identifies Flunarizine as an Inhibitor of Radiotherapy-Induced Astrocyte Reactivity with Therapeutic Potential in Glioblastoma
12:55-13:05	**Felix C. Nebeling**, *University Hospital Bonn / DZNE, Germany* Microglial Regulation of Glioblastoma Dissemination at the Far Infiltration Zone
13:05-14:00	**LUNCH BREAK & POSTER SESSION**

The brain tumor ecosystem

IMMUNOLOGY · MICROENVIRONMENT

DAY 2 — Thursday, 15 October 2026

AFTERNOON PROGRAM & CLOSING SESSION

Pediatric, Low-grade and Rare CNS Tumors

CHAIR: Ilon Liu

14:00-14:20	**Sina Neyazi**, *Dana-Farber, Boston, USA* Project HOPE: A Longitudinal Multidimensional Profiling of High-Grade Gliomas in Children, Adolescents and Young Adults
14:20-14:40	**Simon Zeuner**, *DKFZ/KiTZ, Heidelberg, Germany* Repurposing Statins as Senolytics in Pediatric Low-Grade Glioma Leverages Mevalonate Pathway Dependency in Oncogene-Induced Senescence
14:40-15:00	**Kevin Lu**, *Dana-Farber, Boston, USA* Co-Targeting Gangliosides to Overcome Antigen Heterogeneity in H3-Wildtype Pediatric High-Grade Glioma
15:00-15:10	**Simay Çelikyürekli**, *DKFZ/KiTZ, Heidelberg, Germany* Combined CDK9 and BET Inhibition Induces Apoptosis in H3K27M Pediatric Diffuse Midline Gliomas through Translational Suppression and Replication Stress
15:10-15:20	**Klejdi Nurellari**, *Universitätsklinikum Freiburg, Germany* Integrated Spatial Profiling Identifies a Recruitment-Deficient Lymphocyte-Cold State in Meningioma
15:20-16:20	**COFFEE BREAK & POSTER SESSION**

Functional Genetics and Next-generation Brain Tumor Models

CHAIR: Matthias Schmitt

16:20-17:00	KEYNOTE **Daniel Schramek**, *Lunenfeld-Tanenbaum, Toronto* Decoding Aneuploidies in Glioma - Using CRISPR Technologies in Mice to Unravel Novel Cancer Driver Genes and Vulnerabilities in Recurrent CNA
17:00-17:30	**Poster prize and closing remarks** *Scientific Committee*

The brain tumor diversity

PEDIATRIC AND LOW-GRADE GLIOMAS

INFO

Meeting information

BRAIN TUMOR MEETING 2026 · 12TH EDITION

Venue & registration

MAX DELBRÜCK CENTER FOR MOLECULAR MEDICINE

Main venue

MDC.C (Building 83)
Robert-Rössle-Str. 10
13125 Berlin, Germany
Extended symposium: Stadgut historic wooden barn

MEETING WEBSITE
www.mdc-berlin.de/BTM2026

PROGRAM & UPDATES

Committees

Scientific Program Committee

Charlotte Flüh — clinician, neurosurgery
Gaetano Gargiulo — GBM, biology
Rainer Glass — GBM, biology
Ilon Liu — GBM, clinician, neuro-oncology
Michela Serresi — metastasis, biology

Organizing Committee

Gaetano Gargiulo — MDC
Matthias Runow — MDC
Matthias Schmitt — MDC
Pilar Sanchez-Bailon — MDC
Michela Serresi — MDC

Finding paths through brain tumor complexity

